## 2.2 Meaning

Planning is the primary of all managerial functions. Planning means deciding in advance what to do, when to do it, how to do it, and who is to do it. It bridges the gap between where we are and where we want to go. It is the management function that involves setting goal and deciding how to achieve them in a best manner. It is an intellectual process of thinking before doing. Planning helps to see in advance those things that can help to achieve the goal. The basic objective of planning is to work in a systematic manner to achieve with maximum efficiency and to reduce risk. Planning is done at all levels of management, keeping past events as base for planning to attain the future goal.




**Figure 2.1** Planning- meaning

## 2.3 Definition

According to G.R.Terry," **planning is the foundation of most successful actions of all enterprises.**

**"Planning is deciding the best alternative among others to perform different managerial operations in order to achieve the predetermined goal**- Henry Foyal.

**Planning is deciding in advance what is to be done. It involves the selection of the objectives, -policies, procedures, and programmes from among alternatives** – M.E.Hurley.

## 2.4 Nature of Planning (Characteristics or features of planning)

The following are the essential characteristics of planning:

1. **Planning is a primary function of management:**

   The functions of management are planning, organising, staffing, directing and controlling. Planning is the first function in all levels of management and is involved in all management functions. So it is called as an essence of management.

2. **Planning focuses on goals:**

   Planning is a process to determine the goal of the organisation. It lays down the ways to achieve the goals, in the most effective and efficient manner. It safeguards the business against idle time loss, loss due to surplus labour etc.

3. **Planning is a function of all managers:**

   Planning is done by all levels of managers. Top level managers prepare long term plans for the business as whole, middle level managers prepare departmental plans. Lower level managers prepare to carry out the daily routine work.

4. **Planning is an intellectual process:**

   Planning is a mental work; it is concerned with thinking before doing. It is an intellectual process, so it involves creative thinking and imagination.



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